

B"H

The Mitzvot of Purim

LISTEN TO THE MEGILLAH

To relive the miraculous events of Purim, listen to the reading of the Megillah (*the scroll of shter*) twice: once on Purim eve. Wednesday night, March 23, 2016 and again on Purim day, March 24, 2016.



SEND FOOD PORTIONS TO FRIENDS

(Mishloach Manot)

On Purim we emphasize the importance of Jewish unity and friendship by sending gifts of food to friends. On Purim day, March 24, 2016, send a gift of at least two kinds of ready-to-eat foods (e.g. pastry, fruit, beverage), to at least one friend.



GIVE TO THE NEEDY (Matanot Laevyonim)

Concern for the needy is a year-round responsibility; but on Purim it is a special Mitzvah to remember the poor. Give charity to at least two (but preferably more) needy individuals on Purim day, March 24, 2016.



EAT, DRINK, AND BE MERRY

Purim should be celebrated with a special festive meal on Purim day, at which family and friends gather together to rejoice in the Purim spirit. It is a Mitzvah to drink wine or other inebriating drinks at this meal.



Happy Purim!

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MITZVAH RECYCLING



In the strictest sense, recycling of a material would produce a fresh supply of the same material, so to the performance of a Mitzvah should produce a fresh Mitzvah.

To understand this we should explore what is a Mitzvah.

The simple meaning of the word mitzvah is commandment. The Talmud mentions that the Jewish People were given 613 Mitzvot (commandments) at Sinai.

In common usage, a Mitzvah means “a good deed”—as in “Do a mitzvah and help Mrs. Goldstein with her packages.”

Additionally, the word Mitzvah is related to the Aramaic word “tzavta” meaning to attach or join. In this sense, a mitzvah connects the person who is commanded and the Commander, creating a personal relationship and essential bond.

These three meanings can themselves be bundled together. “Good” is defined as that which the Creator of the universe wants done with His universe, and by doing that which the Creator wants done, we are bound up with Him in body, mind and soul.

When one experiences this awesome bond of a Mitzvah with its tri-dimensional effect, it automatically pulls him along to do another Mitzvah.

With prayers, that our Mitzvot collectively will bring about the ultimate Good with the coming of Moshiach now, when at last we will see the true beauty of each Mitzvah done.